



3-Minute Bible Discussion Guide

What does it mean to live in covenant?

OPENING PRAYER

Eternal God, you are the one who remains ever-faithful to your children. As we turn to Scripture, let these ancient words remind us that you live in relationship with your people, and that we belong to you and to one another. As we think of our own unsteady places in life, remind us that you are a covenant God and that you will never abandon us. In the name of your Son Jesus Christ we pray. *Amen.*

SCRIPTURE READING

Exodus 19: 1-8 – [LINK HERE](#)

(Read aloud as a group.)

WATCH VIDEO

3-Minute Bible (*Understanding Covenants*) – [LINK HERE](#)

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. The setting of this Scripture is the Desert of Sinai. Before this moment, the Israelites had escaped from slavery in Egypt, with Moses leading the way. They are free, but landless, vulnerable, and now seemingly stuck in the wilderness. As careful readers, what can we infer about what life was like for the Israelites in this moment? What emotions might they be feeling about God, their circumstances, or otherwise?
2. In verse 4, God opens his message to the Israelites not with a command, but rather a reminder. What is the reminder? Drawing on what we learn in the video about biblical covenants, why might God begin his message in this way? How would such a message address the concerns of the Israelites in that moment?
3. Even as the Israelites are living in the wilderness, God says, “I bore you on eagles’ wings and brought you *to myself*.” What does this suggest about the relationship between living in wilderness places, on the one hand, and our relationship with God, on the other? How have your own periods of uncertainty affected your relationship with God?
4. In verse 5, God calls the Israelites to “keep [God’s] covenant.” Specific details of *how* to keep the covenant (in particular, by following the Ten Commandments) won’t come until later in the Exodus story. For now, God’s concern seems to be pointing the Israelites back to their identity. What is this identity? What difference does it make that God tells the people *who* they are before telling them *what* to do?

5. When God states “you shall be my treasured possession,” the “you” is plural. God’s covenant is established between God and an entire community, binding us together as a people of faith. In your experience, what strengthens that bond? What tends to strain or weaken it?

CLOSING PRAYER

Gracious God, you have called us as your own to be your holy people. As we go out into the world, give us courage to live out our covenant relationship with you and one another, remembering that our true identity is rooted in your love, grace, and mercy. Even as we wander in our own wildernesses, keep us faithful to you, to each other, and to the communities we serve. In the name of your Son Jesus Christ we pray. *Amen.*
